HealthyMe

A mobile app that helps adults cook healthier meals with confidence

1. Project Overview

HealthyMe is a mobile application designed to help adults adopt healthier eating habits by simplifying home cooking.

While many people want to eat healthier, they often struggle with **time constraints, lack of cooking confidence, and difficulty deciding what to cook daily**. HealthyMe solves this problem by providing **personalized recipe recommendations, ingredient-based suggestions, and guided cooking support.**

The goal of the product is to transform healthy cooking from a **complex task into an easy daily habit.**

2. The Problem

Healthy eating often fails not because people lack motivation, but because the cooking process feels overwhelming.

Through initial exploration of recipe platforms and user behaviour, several challenges emerged:

Too much deciding

Users spend too much time **deciding what to cook**

Wrong assumptions

Most recipe platforms assume users already know **what they want to make**

Beginner struggles

Beginners struggle to follow complicated instructions

Ingredient confusion

Users often have ingredients but **don't know how to combine them**

Phone inconvenience

Cooking while using a phone can be inconvenient

These issues make healthy cooking **time-consuming and mentally exhausting**, leading many people to rely on takeout or unhealthy ready-to-eat food.

3. Research

To better understand the problem space, I conducted **secondary research and informal user interviews with working professionals and beginner cooks.**

Key insights

1 Decision fatigue is real

Users often open recipe apps but spend too long browsing before choosing a meal.

> "I open recipe apps and scroll for 15 minutes. Sometimes I give up and just order food."

2 People want quick healthy options

Most users look for recipes that can be prepared within **20–30 minutes**.

3 Beginners need confidence

Many adults feel intimidated by complex recipes with too many ingredients.

> "I want something simple. If a recipe has 20 steps, I skip it."

4 People cook based on available ingredients

Users often start cooking by checking **what's already in their fridge** rather than searching for a specific dish

4. Opportunity

The research revealed an opportunity to design a product that:

- Reduces decision fatigue
- Helps users cook with available ingredients
- Simplifies recipes for beginners
- Guides users during the cooking process

This insight became the foundation of the HealthyMe experience.

5. Target Users

HealthyMe focuses on adults who want to cook healthier meals but need **simplicity and guidance.**

User Group 1: Beginner Cook

Age: 24–35

Occupation: Working professional

Goal: Learn basic cooking skills and eat healthier.

Pain Points

- Doesn't know where to start
- Feels intimidated by complex recipes
- Struggles to cook after long workdays

User Group 2: Health-Conscious Professional

Age: 28–40

Goal: Maintain a healthy lifestyle despite a busy schedule.

Pain Points

- Limited time to cook
- Difficulty planning meals
- Wants balanced nutrition

6. User Persona

Persona: Riya Sharma

Age

29

Profession

Marketing Manager

Location

Bangalore

Riya works long hours and wants to maintain a healthy lifestyle. She prefers cooking at home but often feels overwhelmed deciding what to cook after work.

She usually checks her fridge to see what ingredients she has but struggles to find recipes that match those ingredients.

Goals

- Cook healthy meals regularly
- Reduce reliance on food delivery
- Learn simple cooking techniques

Frustrations

- Recipe apps feel cluttered
- Many recipes require too many ingredients
- Hard to follow instructions while cooking

7. User Journey

Current Experience (Before HealthyMe)

01

User opens a recipe app

02

Scrolls through many recipes

03

Gets overwhelmed by options

04

Checks fridge for ingredients

05

Realises missing ingredients

06

Ends up ordering food

Improved Experience (With HealthyMe)

01

User opens the app

02

Personalised recipes appear immediately

03

User selects ingredients they already have

04

App suggests quick recipes

05

Guided cooking mode helps during preparation

06

User successfully cooks a healthy meal

8. Design Goals

Three key principles guided the product design.

a) Reduce cognitive load

Users should quickly decide what to cook without endless browsing.

b) Build cooking confidence

Recipes must feel approachable and achievable.

c) Support users during cooking

The app should assist users throughout the cooking process.

Competitive Analysis

Feature	Yummly	Tasty	Hebbar Kitchen
Personalized recommendations	✓	Limited	✕
Video-based learning	Limited	✓	✓
Ingredient-based recipe suggestions	✓	✕	✕
Guided cooking mode	Limited	Limited	✕
Meal planner	✓	✕	✕
Indian recipe focus	Limited	Limited	✓
Health-focused cooking	Partial	Limited	Partial

9. Information Architecture

The product structure focuses on the main cooking journey.

Core Navigation: Home · Recipes · Meal Planner · Profile

Smart Home Screen

The home screen helps users quickly discover recipes without overwhelming them.

Ingredient-Based Recipe Discovery

The **“What’s In Your Fridge”** feature allows users to select ingredients they already have.

Guided Cooking Mode

Cooking mode provides a distraction-free experience during meal preparation.

Meal Planner

Saved recipes and user activity.The meal planner allows users to organize meals for the week.

Design Decisions

Several UI decisions were made to improve usability.

Simple layout structure

A clean interface prevents cognitive overload.

Large typography

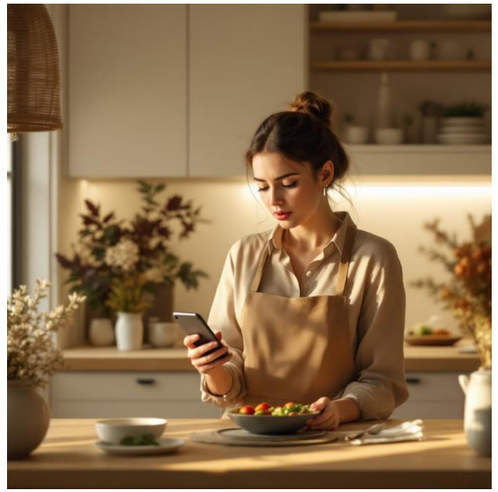
Improves readability while cooking.

Minimal steps per screen

Reduces friction during the cooking journey.

Design Challenges

During the design process, several UX challenges emerged.



Challenge 1: Reducing Decision Fatigue

Recipe apps typically contain thousands of recipes, which can overwhelm users.

Solution

- Curated recipe lists
- Quick recipes under 30 minutes
- Personalized recommendations

This helps users decide what to cook faster.

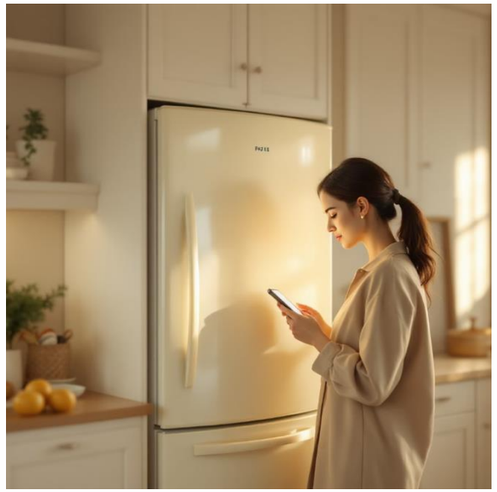
Challenge 2: Supporting Users While Cooking

Users often struggle to interact with their phones while cooking.

Solution

- Large readable instructions
- Voice commands
- Step-by-step navigation

This allows users to cook without constantly touching their phone.



Challenge 3: Helping Users Cook With Available Ingredients

Users frequently look at their fridge before deciding what to cook.

Solution

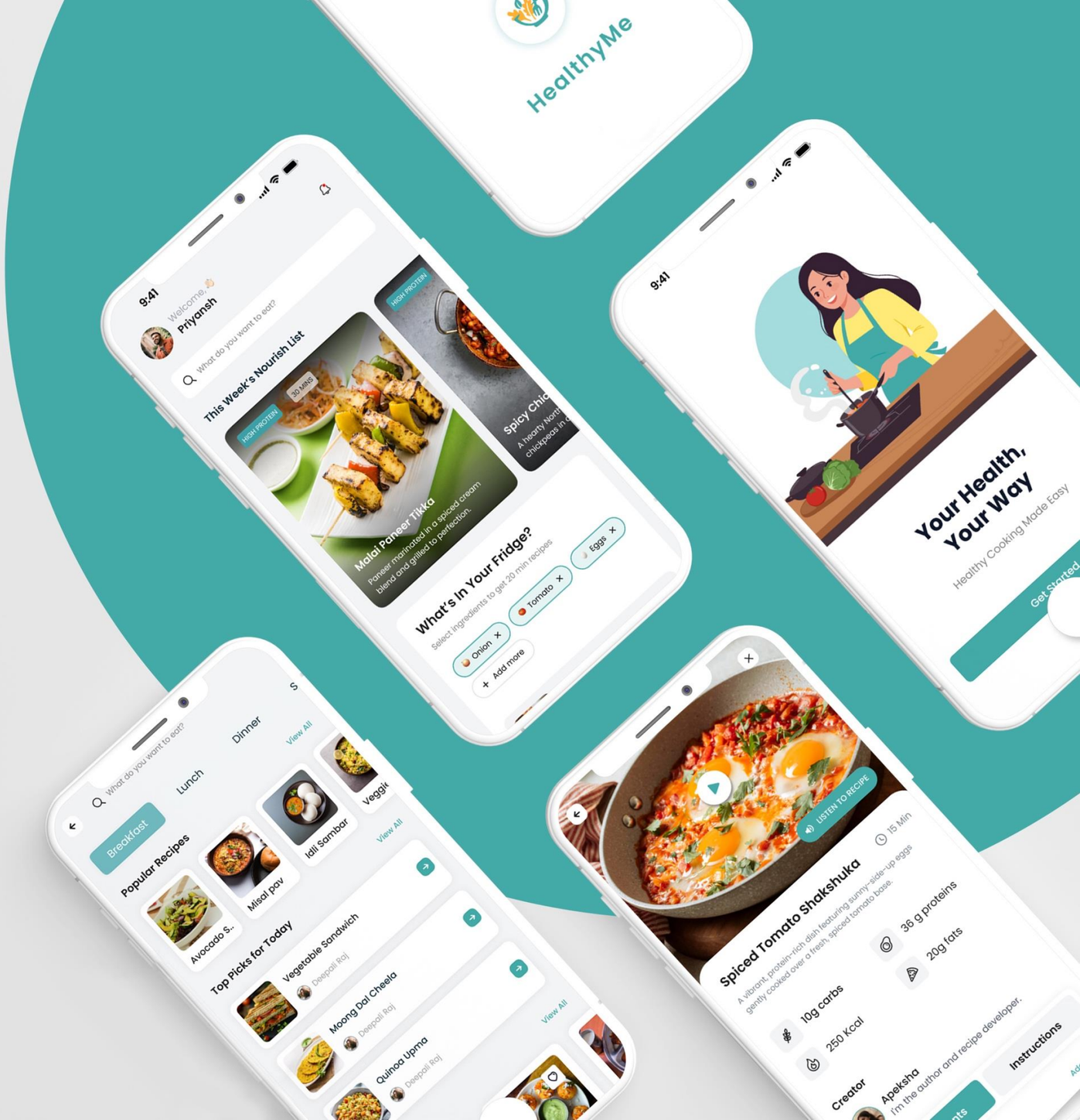
The **“What's in Your Fridge”** feature enables users to select ingredients and receive recipe suggestions, reducing food waste and simplifying meal decisions.

Prototype

To evaluate the usability of HealthyMe, I created a high-fidelity interactive prototype that simulates the core cooking journey of the app. The prototype demonstrates how users can discover recipes, plan meals, and follow guided cooking instructions through a seamless mobile experience.

The goal of this prototype was to validate whether the interface successfully reduces decision fatigue and supports users throughout the cooking process.

HealthyMe App Prototype



Next Steps

Future iterations of HealthyMe could include:

- AI-based ingredient recognition using camera input
- Smart grocery list generation
- Nutrition tracking and calorie goals
- Personalized weekly meal planning
- Video-based cooking tutorials

These improvements could transform HealthyMe into a **complete digital cooking assistant.**